

Juan Manuel Copia

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Summary

*Software Engineer and PhD researcher specializing in **program analysis, automated testing, and AI-assisted software engineering**. I build cloud-native services at Amazon using **AWS, TypeScript, IaC, and CI/CD**, and I have strong hands-on experience using **LLM coding agents and custom agent skills** for debugging, refactoring, test generation, and developer-productivity automation.*

Experience

Software Development Engineer, Amazon – Madrid, Spain May 2025 – Feb 2026

- Quickly ramped up in Amazon's large-scale development environment, mastering internal tools, deployment processes, and operational best practices.
- Designed, implemented, and deployed high-impact services using **React** and **AWS technologies** such as **API Gateway, Lambda, S3, DynamoDB**.
- Developed and maintained **infrastructure as code** using **AWS CDK (TypeScript), IAM, CloudFormation** and **CloudWatch** ensuring reproducibility and scalability across environments in different regions.
- Built agent skills to automate complex debugging workflows and support developer productivity in day-to-day engineering tasks.
- Contributed to **continuous integration and deployment pipelines**, improving reliability and reducing release cycle time.
- Participated in **peer code reviews**, ensuring code quality, maintainability, and adherence to Amazon's software engineering standards.
- Participated in the team's on-call rotation to ensure service reliability and rapid incident resolution
- Mentored new hires during onboarding, helping them integrate into the team and learn Amazon's development and operational practices.

Research Assistant, IMDEA Software Institute – Madrid, Spain Dec 2020 – April 2025

- Designed and implemented a novel Symbolic Execution framework to handle complex heap-allocated inputs. Addressed a key challenge in lazy initialization, improving analysis precision and eliminating false alarms.
- Developed an efficient solver for structural constraints over partially symbolic heaps.
- Developed and applied search-based techniques to automate precondition inference.
- Developed a research prototype combining Large Language Models (LLMs), random test input generation, and program analysis to support patch correctness validation in Java programs.

Research Scholarship, Department of Computer Science – UNRC, Argentina Oct 2019 – Oct 2020

- Built a Python-based Symbolic Execution engine with support for lazy initialization, enabling automated reasoning for heap-allocated objects.
- Applied the Symbolic Execution engine to generate automated test inputs, successfully identifying a critical bug in an educational open-source data structure.

Summer Internship, McAfee – Córdoba, Argentina Jan 2019 – Mar 2019

- Performed fuzz testing on internal software components, uncovering crashes and weaknesses that enhanced the software's robustness and reliability.

Student Teaching Assistant, Department of Computer Science – UNRC, Argentina Aug 2018 – Aug 2019

- Supported undergraduate students in 'Data Structures' and 'Algorithms', focusing on algorithm design, implementation, and problem-solving.

Education

- PhD in Computer Science**, *Universidad Politécnica de Madrid – Madrid, Spain* Oct 2021 – Expected April 2026
- Undergraduate degree in Computer Science (5-year degree + thesis)** Mar 2015 – Dec 2020
Department of Computer Science, UNRC, Argentina
- GPA: 9.02/10.0
- Undergraduate degree in Computer Science (Intermediate 3-year degree + final project)** Mar 2015 – Jun 2018
Department of Computer Science, UNRC, Argentina
- GPA: 8.81/10.0

Publications

- Search-based Inference of Class Invariants: How far can Simulated Annealing take us?** Accepted – To appear 2026
J. M. Copia, F. Molina, N. Aguirre, M. Frias, A. Gorla, P. Ponzio.
To appear in Symposium on Search-Based Software Engineering (SSBSE) 2025, Seoul, Republic of Korea
- Search-based Inference of Class Invariants (Poster)** Aug 2025
J. M. Copia, F. Molina, N. Aguirre, M. Frias, A. Gorla, P. Ponzio.
2025 Genetic and Evolutionary Computation Conference (GECCO), Malaga, Spain
doi: 10.1145/3712255.3726698
- Improving Patch Correctness Analysis via Random Testing and Large Language Models** May 2024
F. Molina, *J. M. Copia*, A. Gorla.
2024 IEEE Conference on Software Testing, Verification and Validation (ICST), Toronto, ON, Canada, 2024, pp. 317-328.
doi: 10.1109/ICST60714.2024.00036
- Precise Lazy Initialization for Programs with Complex Heap Inputs** Oct 2023
J. M. Copia, F. Molina, N. Aguirre, M. Frias, A. Gorla, P. Ponzio.
2023 IEEE 34th International Symposium on Software Reliability Engineering (ISSRE), Florence, Italy, 2023, pp. 752-762.
doi: 10.1109/ISSRE59848.2023.00080
- LISSA: Lazy Initialization with Specialized Solver Aid** Oct 2022
J. M. Copia, P. Ponzio, N. Aguirre, A. Gorla, M. Frias.
37th IEEE/ACM International Conference on Automated Software Engineering (ASE '22). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Article 67, 1–12.
doi: 10.1145/3551349.3556965
- Use of Test Doubles in Android Testing: An In-Depth Investigation** May 2022
M. Fazzini, C. Choi, *J. M. Copia*, G. Lee, Y. Kakehi, A. Gorla, A. Orso.
2022 IEEE/ACM 44th International Conference on Software Engineering (ICSE), Pittsburgh, PA, USA, 2022, pp. 2266-2278.
doi: 10.1145/3510003.3510175

Research Prototypes

- **Express:** A tool that automatically infers method preconditions and class invariants using search-based algorithms. It specializes in generating executable predicates (Java code) as preconditions for complex heap-allocated objects. **Available at:** github.com/JuanmaCopia/express
- **FixCheck:** A tool for improving patch correctness analysis in Java. It integrates static analysis, random testing, and large language models (LLMs) to automatically generate tests that highlight and explain potential patch inconsistencies. **Available at:** github.com/facumolina/fixcheck
- **PLI:** A Symbolic Execution framework built on top of Java Symbolic PathFinder (JPF). It enhances symbolic analysis for programs with complex heap-allocated inputs and intricate preconditions. PLI addresses key challenges in lazy initialization, enabling more precise and efficient symbolic reasoning. **Available at:** github.com/JuanmaCopia/spf-pli
- **SymSolve:** An efficient bounded exhaustive solver for symbolic structures with complex representation invariants. It determines the satisfiability of partially symbolic heaps with respect to structural constraints by leveraging operational specifications (e.g., repOk routines). **Available at:** github.com/JuanmaCopia/SymSolve
- **PySEAT:** A Symbolic Execution engine for Python programs that implements lazy initialization to represent heap-allocated objects symbolically. It automates test generation for Python codebases, achieving high coverage and uncovering potential errors in complex systems. **Available at:** github.com/JuanmaCopia/PySEAT

Public Talks

Precise Lazy Initialization for Programs with Complex Heap Inputs <i>Workshop, KLEE WORKSHOP ON SYMBOLIC EXECUTION, Lisbon, Portugal.</i>	Apr 2024
Precise Lazy Initialization for Programs with Complex Heap Inputs <i>Research Track, ISSRE 2023, Florence, Italy.</i>	Oct 2023
LISSA: Lazy Initialization with Specialized Solver Aid <i>Research Track, ASE 2022, Oakland Center, Michigan, USA.</i>	Oct 2022
LISSA: Lazy Initialization with Specialized Solver Aid <i>Oral communication, IMDEA SOFTWARE S3 SEMINAR SERIES, Madrid, Spain.</i>	Sep 2022
A Satisfiability Solver for Symbolic Structures with Complex Representation Invariants <i>Oral communication, FACAS 2022, La Falda, Córdoba, Argentina.</i>	Mar 2022

Technical Skills

Agentic Tooling & AI-assisted Development: LLM coding agents, OpenAI Agents SDK, MCPs, custom agent skills, debugging automation, refactoring support, test generation, developer automation.

Programming Languages: Python, Java, TypeScript.

Cloud/DevOps (AWS): EC2, Lambda, S3, DynamoDB, SQS, SNS, API Gateway, CloudWatch, IAM.

Infrastructure as Code: AWS CDK (TypeScript), CloudFormation.

Machine Learning / Data: PyTorch, scikit-learn, NumPy, pandas.

Research & Analysis: Symbolic Execution, Static and Dynamic Analysis, Automatic Test Generation, Fuzzing.

Software Engineering: Unit/Integration Testing, Code Review, Continuous Integration/Deployment (CI/CD).

Tools & Frameworks: Git, GitHub, Docker, Dagger, Lombok, JUnit, React, Smithy, Mockito.

Languages

Spoken Languages: English (Fluent/Professional Working Proficiency), Spanish (Native), French (Fluent/Professional Working Proficiency)